# CASE STUDY METHOD AND ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

**EIGHT-ELEMENT CASE-STUDY RAIL → CONSTRAINT GATE BEFORE OPTION → SIX-CHECK EVALUATION MATRIX → CONFLICT-OF-INTEREST RESOLUTION SEQUENCE → NESTED DILEMMA AND STEELMAN → RESIDUAL-RISK CLOSING FORMULA**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

## 00 STAGE 00 — EIGHT-ELEMENT CASE-STUDY RAIL

EIGHT-ELEMENT CASE-STUDY RAIL · CENTRAL FOCUS · 1. EIGHT-ELEMENT CASE-STUDY RAIL · (1) FACTS · GIVEN VERSUS ASSUMED · (2) STAKEHOLDERS · DIRECT AND SILENT · (3) CONSTRAINTS

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 1. Eight-element case-study rail
- [1] Facts: given versus assumed
- [2] Stakeholders: direct and silent
- [3] Constraints: hard bounds

**MECHANISM**
- [4] Options: three or more
- [5] Evaluation: theories and checks
- [6] Decision: decisive reason
- [7] Implementation: actor and message
- [8] Residual risk: monitor and review

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- VERDICT → A case answer is a complete decision process, not a moral reaction.
- ANSWER USE → Use as the universal opening architecture.
- MUST REMEMBER: Every case study requires fact-assumption separation, stakeholder mapping…

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → A case answer is a complete decision process, not a moral reaction.**

## 01 STAGE 01 — CONSTRAINT GATE BEFORE OPTION DESIGN

CONSTRAINT GATE BEFORE OPTION DESIGN · CENTRAL FOCUS · 2. CONSTRAINT GATE BEFORE OPTION DESIGN · (1) LEGALITY DEFINES PERMISSION · (2) DELEGATION DEFINES AUTHORITY · (3) JURISDICTION DEFINES FORUM · (4) TIME DEFINES URGENCY · (5) INFORMATION DEFINES CONFIDENCE

CENTRAL FOCUS → 2. Constraint gate before option design → [1] Legality defines permission → [2] Delegation defines authority → [3] Jurisdiction defines forum

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 2. Constraint gate before option design
- [1] Legality defines permission
- [2] Delegation defines authority
- [3] Jurisdiction defines forum

**MECHANISM**
- [4] Time defines urgency
- [5] Information defines confidence
- [6] Resources define capacity
- [7] Safety defines tolerable exposure
- [8] Survivors become real options

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- VERDICT → Impossible or unlawful proposals should never enter later balancing.
- ANSWER USE → Use before listing options in every administrative case.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Hard thresholds such as illegality or serious rights violation differ…

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Impossible or unlawful proposals should never enter later balancing.**

## 02 STAGE 02 — SIX-CHECK EVALUATION MATRIX

SIX-CHECK EVALUATION MATRIX · CENTRAL FOCUS · 3. SIX-CHECK EVALUATION MATRIX · (1) CONFLICT · HARD THRESHOLD · (2) LEGALITY · (3) PUBLIC INTEREST · (4) PROPORTIONALITY

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| CENTRAL FOCUS | [4] Proportionality: weighted | VERDICT → Eliminate first, weigh second and explain what controlled the choice. |
| 3. Six-check evaluation matrix | [5] Transparency: weighted | ANSWER USE → Use for the ethical-evaluation element. |
| [1] Conflict: hard threshold | [6] Compassion: weighted | EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: The model answer must be executable: immediate… |
| [2] Legality: hard threshold | [7] Long-term effects: projected | |

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 3. Six-check evaluation matrix
- [1] Conflict: hard threshold
- [2] Legality: hard threshold
- [3] Public interest: weighted

**MECHANISM**
- [4] Proportionality: weighted
- [5] Transparency: weighted
- [6] Compassion: weighted
- [7] Long-term effects: projected
- [8] Decisive weight: stated

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- VERDICT → Eliminate first, weigh second and explain what controlled the choice.
- ANSWER USE → Use for the ethical-evaluation element.
- EVIDENCE / AUTHORITY / APPLICATION LIMIT: The model answer must be executable: immediate…

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Eliminate first, weigh second and explain what controlled the choice.**

## 03 STAGE 03 — CONFLICT-OF-INTEREST RESOLUTION SEQUENCE

CONFLICT-OF-INTEREST RESOLUTION SEQUENCE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 4. CONFLICT-OF-INTEREST RESOLUTION SEQUENCE · (1) DETECT PERSONAL-INTEREST LINK · (2) DISCLOSE CONNECTION IN WRITING · (3) RECUSE FROM THE DECISION · (4) REFER TO UNTAINTED AUTHORITY · (5) STATE OBJECTIVE CRITERIA

CENTRAL FOCUS → 4. Conflict-of-interest resolution sequence → [1] Detect personal-interest link → [2] Disclose connection in writing → [3] Recuse from the decision

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 4. Conflict-of-interest resolution sequence
- [1] Detect personal-interest link
- [2] Disclose connection in writing

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Recuse from the decision
- [4] Refer to untainted authority
- [5] State objective criteria
- [6] Apply criteria consistently

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Preserve the scoring trail
- [8] Publish or defend the rationale
- VERDICT → Personal honesty cannot substitute for an unconflicted process.
- ANSWER USE → Use in procurement, licensing and privileged-information cases.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Personal honesty cannot substitute for an unconflicted process.**

## 04 STAGE 04 — NESTED DILEMMA AND STEELMAN LOOP

NESTED DILEMMA AND STEELMAN LOOP · CENTRAL FOCUS · 5. NESTED DILEMMA AND STEELMAN LOOP · (1) IDENTIFY DILEMMA ONE · (2) RUN COMPACT ETHICAL CHECKS · (3) IDENTIFY DILEMMA TWO · (4) RUN COMPACT ETHICAL CHECKS · (5) RECOMBINE COMPATIBLE DECISIONS

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 5. Nested dilemma and steelman loop
- [1] Identify dilemma one
- [2] Run compact ethical checks

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Identify dilemma two
- [4] Run compact ethical checks
- [5] Recombine compatible decisions
- [6] State strongest objection

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Absorb valid objection
- [8] Confirm or revise decision
- VERDICT → Decomposition clarifies the problem; steelmanning tests the solution.
- ANSWER USE → Use for dense cases with multiple genuine conflicts.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Decomposition clarifies the problem; steelmanning tests the solution.**

## 05 STAGE 05 — RESIDUAL-RISK CLOSING FORMULA

RESIDUAL-RISK CLOSING FORMULA · CENTRAL FOCUS · 6. RESIDUAL-RISK CLOSING FORMULA · (1) NAME INHERENT DANGER · (2) LIST PREVENTIVE CONTROLS · (3) TEST CONTROL WEAKNESS · (4) ADD UNCERTAINTY EXPOSURE · (5) STATE SURVIVING RISK

CENTRAL FOCUS → 6. Residual-risk closing formula → [1] Name inherent danger → [2] List preventive controls → [3] Test control weakness

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 6. Residual-risk closing formula
- [1] Name inherent danger
- [2] List preventive controls

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Test control weakness
- [4] Add uncertainty exposure
- [5] State surviving risk
- [6] Choose monitoring indicator

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Name accountable authority
- [8] Set review or trigger date
- VERDICT → Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by controls, with uncertainty retained.
- ANSWER USE → Use as the final paragraph of every solved case.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Residual risk equals inherent risk reduced by controls, with uncertainty retained.**

## 06 STAGE 06 — WRITTEN-ORDER RESPONSE TO PRESSURE

WRITTEN-ORDER RESPONSE TO PRESSURE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 7. WRITTEN-ORDER RESPONSE TO PRESSURE · (1) IDENTIFY IMPROPER ORAL DIRECTION · (2) RECORD ITS SUBSTANCE PROMPTLY · (3) SEEK WRITTEN CONFIRMATION · (4) STATE PROFESSIONAL OBJECTION · (5) PRESERVE SUPPORTING EVIDENCE

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Written-order response to pressure
- [1] Identify improper oral direction
- [2] Record its substance promptly

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Seek written confirmation
- [4] State professional objection
- [5] Preserve supporting evidence
- [6] Refer through proper hierarchy

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Continue lawful substantive duty
- [8] Escalate improprietry if persistent
- VERDICT → Writing fixes responsibility and converts private resistance into institutional accountability.
- ANSWER USE → Use for ministerial, superior and corporate pressure.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Writing fixes responsibility and converts private resistance into institutional accountability.**

## 07 STAGE 07 — WHISTLEBLOWING AND DISSENT LADDER

WHISTLEBLOWING AND DISSENT LADDER · CENTRAL FOCUS · 8. WHISTLEBLOWING AND DISSENT LADDER · (1) PRESERVE CREDIBLE EVIDENCE · (2) REPORT TO COMPETENT SUPERIOR · (3) SKIP A COMPROMISED RECIPIENT · (4) USE INDEPENDENT INTERNAL TIER · (5) USE AUTHORISED EXTERNAL CHANNEL

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. Whistleblowing and dissent ladder → [1] Preserve credible evidence → [2] Report to competent superior

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Whistleblowing and dissent ladder
- [1] Preserve credible evidence
- [2] Report to competent superior

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Skip a compromised recipient
- [4] Use independent internal tier
- [5] Use authorised external channel
- [6] Protect identity and safety

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Consider public disclosure last
- [8] Review retaliation and follow-up
- VERDICT → Escalate only as far as failure and continuing harm require.
- ANSWER USE → Use when loyalty, secrecy and public interest conflict.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Escalate only as far as failure and continuing harm require.**

## 08 STAGE 08 — RESIGNATION DECISION TEST

RESIGNATION DECISION TEST · CENTRAL FOCUS · 9. RESIGNATION DECISION TEST · (1) RECORD PERSONAL NON-PARTICIPATION · (2) TEST INTERNAL RESISTANCE · (3) TEST INDEPENDENT ESCALATION · (4) ASSESS CONTINUING PUBLIC INFLUENCE · (5) ASSESS COMPLICITY FROM REMAINING

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. Resignation decision test
- [1] Record personal non-participation
- [2] Test internal resistance

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Test independent escalation
- [4] Assess continuing public influence
- [5] Assess complicity from remaining
- [6] Assess impact of departure

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Define the resignation trigger
- [8] Resign only if net protection rises
- VERDICT → Resignation is ethical only when it protects the public better than principled service.
- ANSWER USE → Use whenever an option list includes exit from office.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Resignation is ethical only when it protects the public better than principled service.**

## 09 STAGE 09 — SCARCE-RESOURCE TRIAGE CYCLE

SCARCE-RESOURCE TRIAGE CYCLE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 10. SCARCE-RESOURCE TRIAGE CYCLE · (1) MEASURE ACTUAL SCARCITY · (2) PROTECT LAWFUL BASIC MINIMA · (3) CHOOSE RELEVANT CRITERIA · (4) PUBLISH CRITERIA IN ADVANCE · (5) ADD VULNERABILITY SAFEGUARD

CENTRAL FOCUS → 10. Scarce-resource triage cycle → [1] Measure actual scarcity → [2] Protect lawful basic minima → [3] Choose relevant criteria

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Scarce-resource triage cycle
- [1] Measure actual scarcity
- [2] Protect lawful basic minima

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Choose relevant criteria
- [4] Publish criteria in advance
- [5] Add vulnerability safeguard
- [6] Record each allocation

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Provide rapid review route
- [8] Revise as conditions change
- VERDICT → Transparent criteria are ethically superior to hidden case-by-case discretion.
- ANSWER USE → Use for beds, staff, water, relief and compensation.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Transparent criteria are ethically superior to hidden case-by-case discretion.**

## 10 STAGE 10 — DOMAIN ADAPTATION MAP

DOMAIN ADAPTATION MAP · CENTRAL FOCUS · 11. DOMAIN ADAPTATION MAP · (1) ADMINISTRATION · LAWFUL AUTHORITY · (2) CORPORATE · STAKEHOLDER DUTY · (3) RESEARCH

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| CENTRAL FOCUS | [5] Research: consent and truth | [7] Technology: privacy and harm |
| 11. Domain adaptation map | [6] Health: triage and dignity | [8] Disaster: continuity and compassion |
| [1] Administration: lawful authority | [5] Police: force and due process | VERDICT → The architecture stays constant while standards, institutions and evidence change. |
| [2] Corporate: stakeholder duty | [6] Environment: future generations | ANSWER USE → Use to transfer the method without copying remedies blindly. |

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. Domain adaptation map
- [1] Administration: lawful authority
- [2] Corporate: stakeholder duty

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Research: consent and truth
- [4] Health: triage and dignity
- [5] Police: force and due process
- [6] Environment: future generations

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Technology: privacy and harm
- [8] Disaster: continuity and compassion
- VERDICT → The architecture stays constant while standards, institutions and evidence change.
- ANSWER USE → Use to transfer the method without copying remedies blindly.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The architecture stays constant while standards, institutions and evidence change.**

## 11 STAGE 11 — TIME-BOUND EXAMINER ANSWER SPINE

TIME-BOUND EXAMINER ANSWER SPINE · CENTRAL FOCUS · 12. TIME-BOUND EXAMINER ANSWER SPINE · (1) MINUTE ONE · DEMAND AND FACTS · (2) MINUTE TWO · (3) MINUTE THREE · (4) MINUTES FOUR-SIX

CENTRAL FOCUS → 12. Time-bound examiner answer spine → [1] Minute one: demand and facts → [2] Minute two: stakeholders → [3] Minute three: constraints

**CORE CLAIM**
- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. Time-bound examiner answer spine
- [1] Minute one: demand and facts
- [2] Minute two: stakeholders

**MECHANISM**
- [3] Minute three: constraints
- [4] Minutes four-six: options
- [5] Minutes seven-ten: evaluation
- [6] Minutes eleven-twelve: decision

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- [7] Minutes thirteen-fourteen: execution
- [8] Minute fifteen: residual risk
- VERDICT → Compress every element; do not sacrifice the ending to an oversized introduction.
- ANSWER USE → Use as a planning clock for a twenty-mark case.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Compress every element; do not sacrifice the ending to an oversized introduction.**

## E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · 1. ARCHITECTURE · 2. CONCEPTS AND DISTINCTIONS · 3. DETAILED TREATMENT · 4. INSTITUTIONAL AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE · 5. INDIAN APPLICATIONS AND BOUNDARY CASES · 6. LIMITATIONS AND TRADE-OFFS · 7. MUST-KNOW FACTS FOR ADVANCED PRELIMS

**OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH**
- 1. Architecture
- 2. Concepts and distinctions
- 3. Detailed treatment
- 4. Institutional and reform architecture

**ADVANCED DEBATE**
- 5. Indian applications and boundary cases
- 6. Limitations and trade-offs
- 7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims
- 8. Advanced Prelims traps

**LEGACY / NUANCE**
- 9. Current application
- 10. PYQ-based analytical application
- 11. Mains-ready framework
- 12. Probable questions

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels